

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 3
♥ J 10 9 8 2
♦ Q 10 2
♣ 9 7 4

♠ K J 4

♥ Q 6

♦ 8 5 3

♣ J 10 6 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 8 7 5 2

♥ K 4

♦ K 9 7

♣ Q 8 5

♠ A Q 9

♥ A 7 5 3

♦ A J 6 4

♣ A K

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠5.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

Needing two winners you will naturally consider your 5-card ♣ suit. After unblocking the ♣ A K you will need two entries to your hand; one to lead the ♣J and drive out the ♣Q, then a second to enjoy your good ♣s.

The ♠ suit will provide one entry easily, but should you depend on the ♥Q for the second entry?

No, for two reasons. Firstly the ♥Q only gives you a 50% chance of being an entry. But more importantly, you already have your two sure entries in ♠s. As long as you take the first trick with dummy's ♠A both your ♠K and ♠J can be entries.

Win the ♠A. Play off dummy's ♣ A K. Lead the ♠9 to your ♠J. Play your ♣J (and another one if necessary) to establish the ♣ suit. Win whatever red card they play next with dummy's Ace. Play the ♠Q to your ♠K and cash your established ! C(s). Dummy's other red Ace will be your ninth trick.

The more you make a point of looking for entries the easier they are to find.

You'd have to be very careless to miss this one.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 7
♥ 8 6 5
♦ K Q 7 3
♣ J 9 4 2

♠ K J 9 2
♥ Q 10 9 3
♦ 10 9 5 2
♣ 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 6 4 3
♥ A J 4
♦ A J
♣ A K 8 3

♠ Q 8 5
♥ K 7 2
♦ 8 6 4
♣ Q 10 7 5

West	North	East	South
Pass	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East

Then unblock your ♦ A J. Next play ♣ K. (on which North discards), and a small ♣ toward dummy's ♣ J 9. You are sure to have a ♣ entry to dummy's ♦ s, and you will still get three ♣ tricks, just a different three.

Suppose the opening lead had been a ♦ rather than a ♣.

You probably would have played the hand the same way you just did, unblock ♦ s, then play ♣ A K and a low ♣ toward the ♣ J 9 trying to get a ♣ entry to dummy.

It is only because the ♣ opening lead gives you the chance for a Cheap-Trick that you are tempted to go wrong.

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♣ 5. You play low from dummy and North plays the ♣ 6.

Winners: ♠ = 1 ♥ = 1 ♦ = 4? ♣ = 3 Total = 9

Although you have 4 ♦ winners, getting to the last couple might not be so easy. You can make 3 ♦ tricks simply by winning your ♦ A, then overtaking your ♦ J with dummy's ♦ Q. But you need that fourth ♦ winner. Can you get it?

Sure you can, by creating an entry in ♣ s. It is likely from the opening lead, (and North's play of a small card), that South has led from ♣ Q 10 7 5. If you win the first trick cheaply then you will still make your ♣ A K for three ♣ tricks in all.

So don't win cheaply, win the first trick with the ♣ A. Then unblock your ♦ A J. Next play ♣ K. (on which North discards), and a small ♣ toward dummy's ♣ J 9. You are sure to have a ♣ entry to dummy's ♦ s, and you will still get three ♣ tricks, just a different three.

Board 5

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 10 9 5
♥ A 9 3
♦ 9 8 3
♣ 10 8

♠ 8 3
♥ J 7 4
♦ A 6 4 2
♣ 7 6 5 3



♠ K 7 4 2
♥ Q 10 8 6
♦ 10 7
♣ K 9 2

♠ A 6
♥ K 5 2
♦ K Q J 5
♣ A Q J 4

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	Pass	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			